Board 1
East Deals
None Vul

	♠ 3 ♥ A 8 5 ♦ K J 3 ♣ A Q 8 7 5 4	
♠ J 10 9 2 ♥ 9 6 3 ♦ Q 10 8 2 ♣ 3 2		♠ A 8 7 5 4 ♥ J 10 7 2 ♦ 9 6 5 ♣ J
	♠ K Q 6 ♥ K Q 4 ♦ A 7 4 ♣ K 10 9 6	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		Pass	1NT
Pass	3♣	Pass	4♣
Pass	4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]
Pass	6♣		
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♣ by North
Lead: ♦5

The bidding has been as shown.

You open 1NT and partner responds 3♣. What is your next bid?

Partner's jump to 3♣ shows at least 5 ♣s and slam interest. Your hand is good enough to encourage that interest so you bypass 3NT and say 4♣. Partner now bids 4NT. What do you answer?

That is Blackwood. You admit to one Ace and partner bids 6♣.

Board 2
South Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ J 10 4 3 ♥ A 10 ♦ J 10 3 2 ♣ K 8 4	
♠ K 9 6 ♥ K J 6 4 ♦ A Q 4 ♣ Q J 5		♠ Q 8 ♥ Q 9 8 7 3 2 ♦ 6 ♣ 10 9 6 3
	♠ A 7 5 2 ♥ 5 ♦ K 9 8 7 5 ♣ A 7 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
1NT	Pass	2♥	
All Pass			

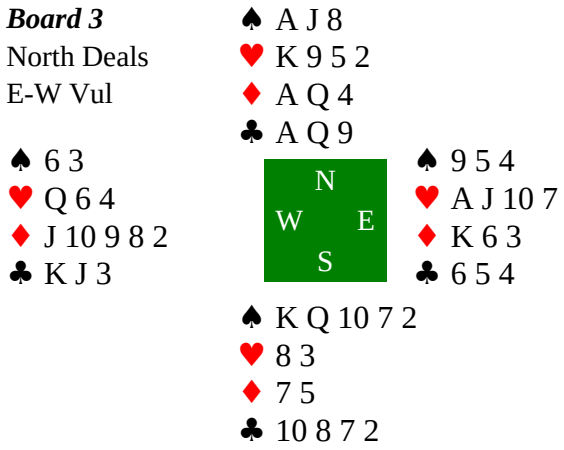
2♥ by East
Lead: ♦5

The bidding has been as shown.

A 1NT overcall is almost the same as a 1NT opening. The range is increased to 15-18, but the main difference is that you **must** have the opponent's suit adequately stopped. Here you certainly have the stopper so you bid 1NT. Partner responds 2♥.

And the responses are the same also. Partner's 2♥ bid is a signoff bid, often called a "drop dead" bid. So even though you really like the ♥s you pass.

Board 3
North Deals
E-W Vul



West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2NT	Pass	3♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♠3

With a balanced 20 point hand you open 2NT. Partner responds 3♠.

Partner is showing a 5-card ♠ suit and at least 5 points. This is a forcing bid; you are to choose between 3NT and 4♠, depending on your ♠ holding. With three of them you bid 4♠.

Board 4
South Deals
Both Vul

♠ J 4 2
♥ 10 8 7 4
♦ Q 8 5
♣ A J 2

♠ A 6
♥ A J 6
♦ K J 6 2
♣ Q 8 6 4

♠ K 9 8 3
♥ K Q 2
♦ 10 7 4
♣ 9 5 3

♠ Q 10 7 5
♥ 9 5 3
♦ A 9 3
♣ K 10 7

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			Pass
1NT			
All Pass			

1NT by West
Lead: ♠4

The bidding has been as shown.

You have 8 points. Even if partner has the maximum 17 it would only add to 25, which is probably not enough to make game. You should pass.

Board 5
North Deals
None Vul

♠ A Q 2
♥ A 9 7
♦ Q 8 3
♣ K Q 10 4

♠ 8 7 6
♥ 8 3
♦ J 6 5 2
♣ A 8 6 2

♠ J 10 5 4
♥ J 10 6 5 4
♦ A K
♣ 9 7

♠ K 9 3
♥ K Q 2
♦ 10 9 7 4
♣ J 5 3

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North
Lead: ♥5

The bidding has been as shown.

With 9 points you have just enough strength for an invitation. So you bid 2NT. Partner then says 3NT and everybody passes.